Newsletter: July 2025

Overview:

Hello River Champions! Here are some of the things we have been up to over the last few months:

- Training Days in May and June
- Welcoming our new Student Intern Asha Gurung, and bid farewell to UoB Leader Cameron Wilkes
- Public engagement events
- Report on how communities value the Cole published



Training Days:

We've held training days on May 4th (Star Wars Day) at Perry Park (below) and June 27th at Cotterills Lane (top right), where the Friends of Perry Park, Berkeley Road and Ward End Residents all received training - and have been subsequently monitoring their local watercourse!



Greetings and Goodbyes:

The university student group recently said a big thank you and goodbye to its leader Cameron Wilkes, who's led monitoring along the Bournbrook on campus and River Rea at Canon Hill.

Along with saying goodbye, let's say hello to our new student intern, Asha Gurung, who will lead the UoB group alongside supporting other volunteer groups in southwest Birmingham.



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Community Engagement Sessions:

We have recently got involved with various family friendly community events. This includes hosting a stand at the University of Birmingham's 125th Anniversary (left), delivering a session at the university's May half-term (middle), and also going into a local school (right) to highlight the fasincations of our underwater world.

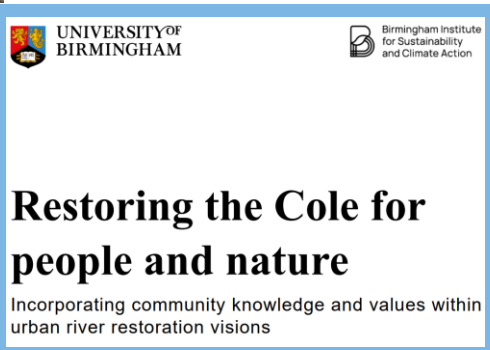






Report on the Cole:

In the previous newsletter, we mentioned a university-led project where we engaged with some of our river champions and other local volunteers on how they value the Cole. We are delighted to say that the report from this is now published and can be downloaded from:



https://www.birmingham.ac.uk/Documents/college-les/restoring-the-cole-for-people-and-nature.pdf.

River Champions Update:

As we are approaching the 2 year mark of this project, here is an update on our work so far. We have now collected **148 Urban Riverfly** samples, **90 Water Chemistry** samples across **23** locations in the Tame, Rea and Cole valleys. This is amazing- please do keep up the amazing efforts!

Reminders:

- Groups can upload their surveys via our **online survey form**.
- Please check out **our website** to see results that **you** have collected.
- Please contact us if you would like **more support**, project partners are keen to help support data collection and help make in impact.

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